Factory

Development as a reproducible system

How we turn messy problems into shipped, verified, documented improvements - without losing context.

epics · review loops · verification gates · observability

Starter deck / 2026-05-19

Why Factory exists

We already have a powerful way of building software. The problem is that too much of it lives in chat history, review comments, shell snippets, and operator memory.

Make it teachable

Turn repeated tactics into reusable patterns.

Make it inspectable

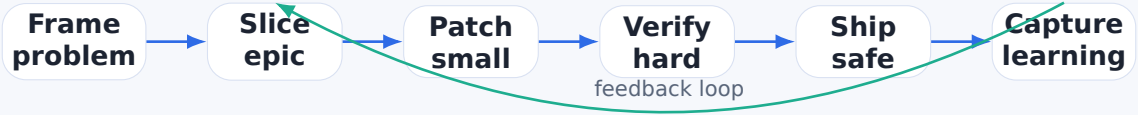
Expose the reasoning, gates, artifacts, and failure modes.

Make it scalable

Let more people use the process without copying folklore.

Factory = process docs + examples + templates + talks + onboarding paths

The process in one sentence



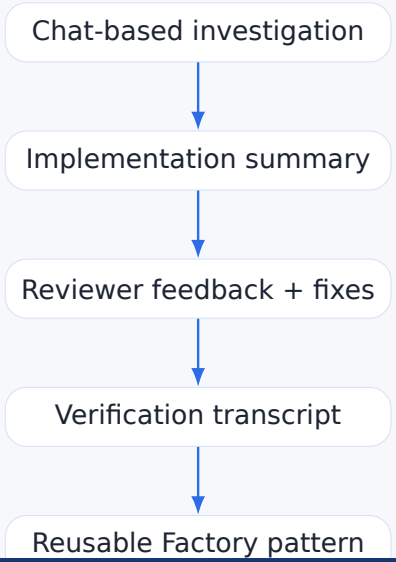
Operating principle

Every change should leave behind enough evidence for a future engineer to understand what changed, why, how it was verified, and what remains risky.

Anti-goal

Do not turn development into ceremony. Factory documents the shortest reliable path from ambiguity to confidence.

Factory converts tacit work into explicit assets



Outputs we want

- Playbooks for recurring work
- Checklists for risky changes
- Example PRs with narrative
- CI/gate design notes
- Debugging recipes
- Onboarding modules

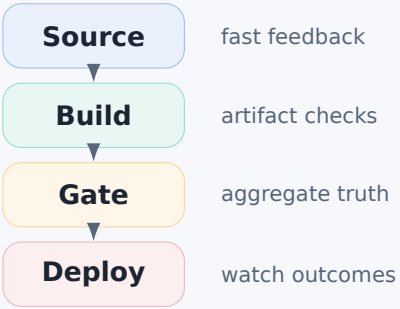
A Factory epic has a standard shape

Part	What gets captured
Problem	Symptom, operator impact, current evidence, constraints.
Plan	Small slices, risk boundaries, verification strategy.
Closeout	Files changed, tests run, unresolved follow-ups, rollout notes.

Verification is part of the product, not a cleanup step

Factory asks for evidence at each layer

- Static checks: format, lint, type checks
- Unit and widget tests
- Integration and fixture regressions
- Artifact sanity checks
- Deployment gates and post-deploy observation



Rule of thumb: if a reviewer can ask “how do we know?”, the Factory artifact should already ans

Review loops are structured, not adversarial

Reviewer role

Find hidden risk, force precision, and turn vague confidence into explicit evidence.

Implementer role

Respond with scoped patches, verification, and concise summaries.

Factory role

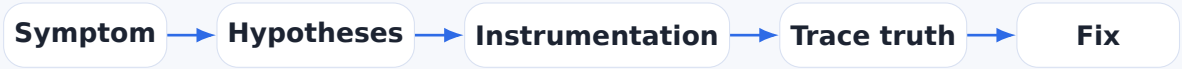
Preserve the pattern: what kind of issue was caught, how it was fixed, and how it becomes a future checklist item.

Outcome

Every review improves both the code and the development system.

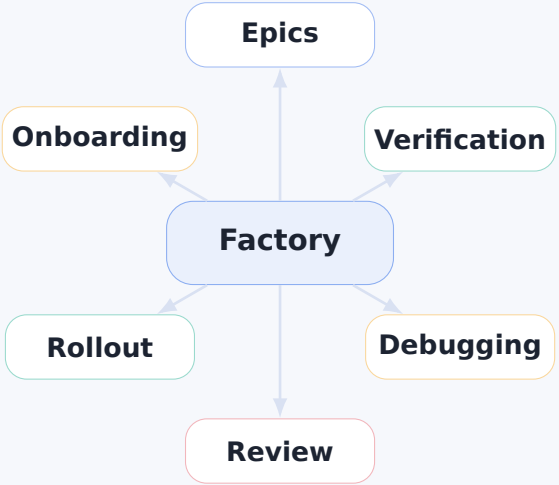
Instrumentation-first debugging

When a system behaves strangely, Factory prefers visibility over guessing.



Examples: timing breakdowns, trace diagnostics, synthetic/no-trace classifications, debug endpoints, stale artifact flags, deployment gate status files.

Factory knowledge map



First content tracks

Track	Starter artifact	Audience
Epic lifecycle	How to run an implementation epic from symptom to closeout	Engineers, tech leads
Verification gates	Artifact-driven CI gates and deployment safety	Platform, DevOps, reviewers
Debugging playbooks	Instrumentation-first trace/debug method	Backend, SRE, support
Review patterns	Turning reviewer comments into reusable checks	Everyone shipping code
Rollout notes	How to ship risky changes with observability	Leads, operators

Start with real examples. Generalize only after the pattern has survived contact with production

Suggested launch plan

1. Seed

Create a short deck, a README, and 2-3 concrete case studies from recent work.

2. Practice

Use Factory language during active epics: plan, evidence, gate, closeout, follow-up.

3. Spread

Turn successful epics into brown bags, onboarding docs, and reusable templates.

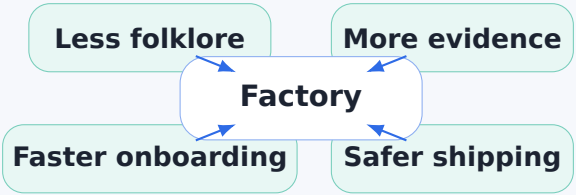
1
shared vocabulary

3
starter tracks

30 min
first internal talk

ongoing
living playbook

What good looks like



The end state is not “more documentation”.
It is a development system that teaches itself.

Factory

Make the way we build as reliable as what we build.

next: turn this deck into the Factory README and first playbook